

UrbanOS — what I've built, and what I need from you

For Mannu · from Shivam · 17 August 2026

The three questions are in the message above and take two minutes to answer. This is the background behind them: about ten minutes, and none of it urgent.

Reply however is fastest: voice note, Hindi, Hinglish, typed, or scribbled on a printout.

This one is for you only. If you want to show someone the map to test interest, send the map, not this.

I have been building for three weeks without asking you a single question, which was a mistake. This is me correcting it.

Where you stand in this

You are not a consultant here and you are not doing me a favour. The circular collection is the company's core asset and it is yours. We have never papered how any of that is owned, and that is a call rather than a document. It should happen before you spend another morning collecting.

One thing I want to be exact about, because it is your professional name. When an entry records that you sourced it, it means *this is a true photograph of a document Mannu obtained at this office on this date*. It never means you warrant that the rule is current or correctly interpreted. The software tracks stays and supersessions separately, and no client-facing sheet ever names a person. **If you would rather your name did not appear at all, say so and it will not.**

What UrbanOS is

Software that works out what the rules currently on record permit on a piece of land, with the drawing, and the government paper behind every number, before the builder spends his money.

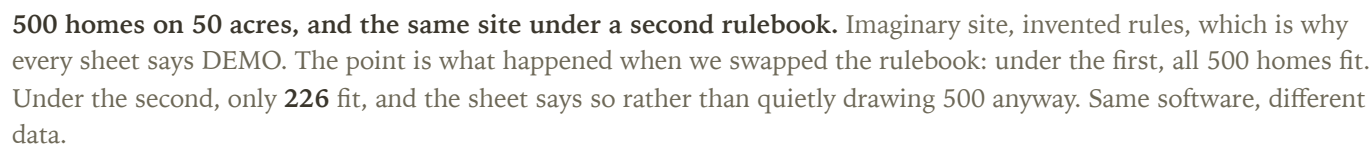
It is an input to professional judgement, never a substitute for it, and it never produces a submission drawing.

A man has a plot, or is about to buy one. Today he asks someone and waits weeks. We want him to walk into his architect's office already knowing the shape of the answer.

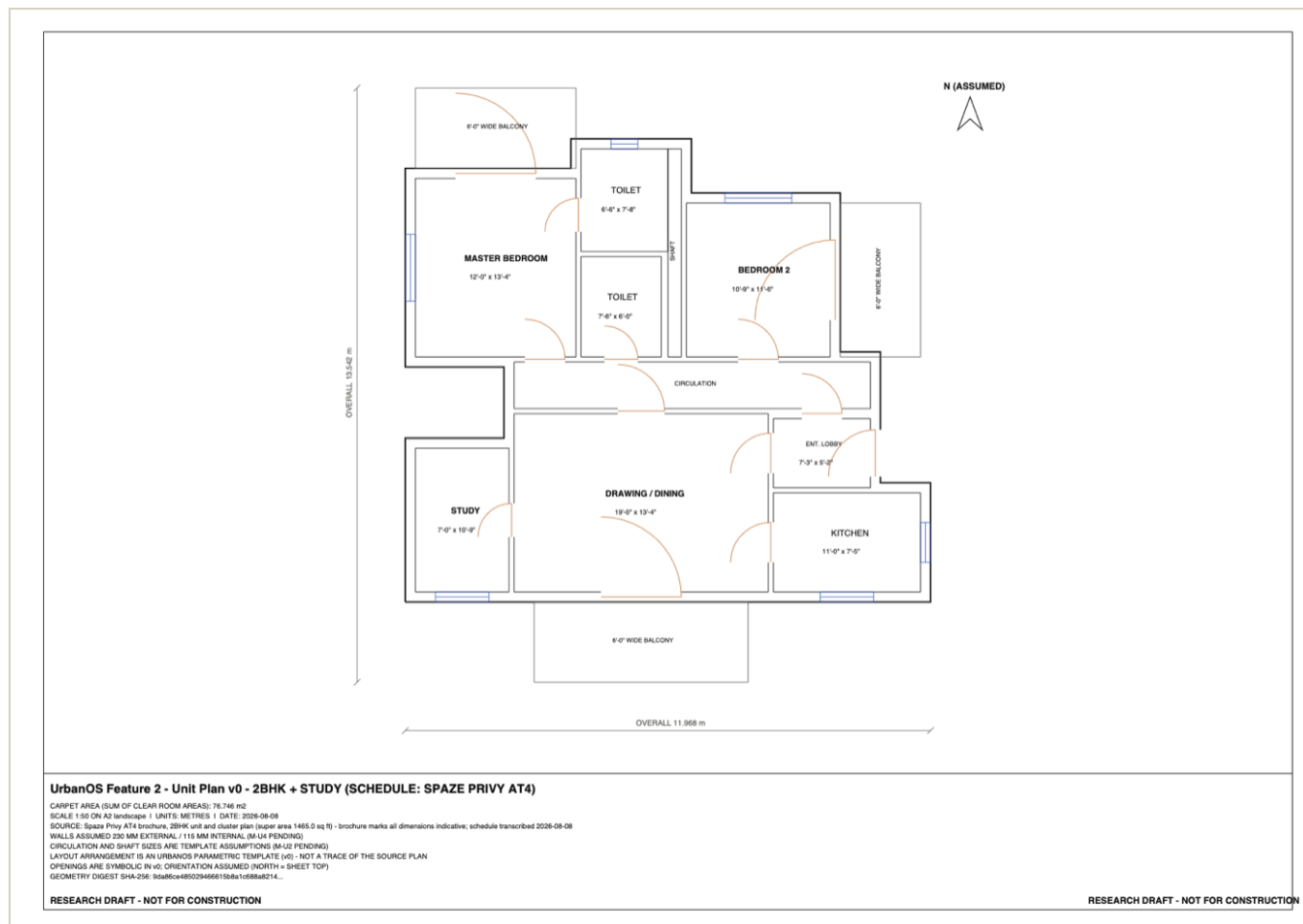
How it is built, in three lines

The rules never sit inside the AI. The AI reads documents and writes prose; the numbers live in the rulebook with their sources attached. **No paper, no number.**

Two things it has already drawn



Two things on this sheet I already know are wrong, so you need not spend your reaction on them: the parking is drawn in front of the houses when the text says stilt, and it is not dimensioned. Tell me what else.



The 2BHK you asked for. Drawn from the dimensions in the AT4 brochure you sent, which I know is a marketing document rather than a measured drawing, so treat the geometry as a first guess. Everything the software had to assume is printed on the sheet rather than hidden. The assumptions I am least sure of are the statutory ones: minimum room and kitchen sizes, WC and bath minimums, light and ventilation ratios, shaft minimums, door and stair widths. And I do not trust the area statement; I am not confident I have kept carpet, built-up and super area properly apart.

Where I got stuck, which is the interesting part

The published code is not hard to find. What I could not do is work out *which* set of figures governs a given plot: licensed colony, HSVP sector or municipal area, which size slab, which road width, and whether a notification or circular has moved a number since. I know these live in amendments and notifications rather than on a web page. That is the whole point.

One example of how it looks from outside. For what appeared to be the same 60 to 150 square metre slab, press reports gave me ground coverage 80 per cent with FAR 200 per cent in one place, and FAR 2.64 in another. Both are newspaper reporting. I have typed neither into anything and I will not.

That is a gap in me, not an absence in the world. But it is also why the papers in your bag beat anything on my screen. **So tell me: is the hard part the numbers, or is it knowing which regime a plot sits under?** If it is the second, I have been building around the wrong problem.

The line we do not cross

The software never says a plan is approved. Every sheet reads either "**Research Draft — Not for Construction**" or "**Prepared for Professional Review**", and the code picks which one. We work things out and we draw; the architect signs, and we never do.

Two questions inside that, and I will take your answer over mine. Do those two wordings read right to a professional, or what would you write instead? And what stops a builder taking our sheet straight to an architect for a stamp without it being properly redrawn? That is the exposure I cannot see from here.

The journey I think a project takes

1 Can anything be built here at all

Title, revenue record, land use under the Development Plan, change of land use where needed, licence, zoning plan. *(not started, and I have probably got this list wrong)*

2 The plan

What the plot permits, worked out and drawn, with the numbers. *(building now)*

3 The approval list

Every clearance this project needs: what each is, which office, in what order. *(next)*

4 The tracker

That list as a board that updates itself, including the objection and resubmission loop, which I gather is where most of the real time goes. The board keeps the record; what to file, in what order, and how to answer an objection stays entirely with you. *(not started)*

5 Filing and completion

Submission, then plinth check, completion and occupation. The software only holds the record. *(not started)*

6 Detailed planning

The drawings construction actually runs on. *(not started)*

That is my guess at the order. Reordering it is the cheapest correction in this document.

What is genuinely open

Two things here I will change this week on your say-so: **the customer, and the first area**. Changing them costs me days rather than months, because the rules are data the software loads rather than code I would have to rewrite. That is why I can afford to mean it.

My assumption on the customer is small plot builders in Gurgaon, because they come back every few months rather than once every few years, and townhouse developers after them. That is reasoning from the outside, not a finding.

On stilt +4: I read that the Punjab and Haryana High Court stayed the policy by an interim order of 2 April 2026, and that a DTCP memorandum of 21 July 2026 suspended fresh approvals and switched the option off on the online submission system. It spoke of fresh approvals and said nothing about plans already sanctioned. I have never held either document.

I also read that Haryana already runs its own automatic scrutiny of submitted drawings. If so, we should never sell checking, because the state gives that away. We sell the answer before a drawing exists, which is the part nobody does.

Money

Pilots get a real invoice at list price, fully waived, so both sides know what the work is worth and nobody learns to expect it free. Premium pricing after. **You set the prices**, and I have drafted a starting number for you to tear up on a call.

One thing I want your read on before that call: you would be the one asking your contacts to take a waived pilot. Does that read as generous in this market, or does it price us at zero permanently?

What I need from you

The three that matter are in the message, so you can answer without opening this. If you answer only one, make it the first.

1 · ONE WORD

Which authority and which area does the rulebook cover first?

Licensed colony, HSVP sector, or municipal area. We build one properly instead of five badly, so pick wherever your own circulars are deepest and the money actually is. Whichever you name is what I build this month, and nothing else starts until it is picked. If I have not heard by Friday the 21st I will pick one and start, and you will be correcting my guess instead of making the call. I would much rather you made it.

2 · ONE SENTENCE

Are Gurgaon plot builders buying and building this month?

Roughly how many plot deals have you seen close since July: none, two, ten? I picked the plot builder as our first customer because he comes back often, and if that cycle has stopped he is not transacting.

Either answer is usable, so give me the true one. If the plot market is frozen, the same software points at townhouse developers instead, or at whatever is actually sanctionable. The rules are data, so changing target costs days rather than months. Nothing you tell me here wastes the work.

3 · FIRST REACTION

The community map: what is wrong with it?

Parking aside, which I already know about. And then the more useful version of the same question: **what must a scheme like this actually show before a professional would take it seriously?** I do not think I have allowed for an EWS or affordable component, community and school sites, the sector road and right of way, green belt, or open space as a percentage of net planned area. That list is worth more to me than a reaction to the rendering.

Whenever, or never. None of these are blocking anything:

— **The rule model.** I have assumed a rule is a number plus the conditions it applies under: ground coverage, FAR, height and permissible number of storeys, setbacks per side, dwelling units permitted per plot, stilt conditions, basement, parking as ECS, permissible projections, minimum frontage, and thresholds that trigger extra obligations. Strike out what is wrong and add what is missing. And the bigger half of the question: **how much of your real work is a clean number at all**, rather than discretion, relaxations, officer-imposed conditions, or a zoning plan sitting on top?

— **How a rule is stored.** I have guessed the instrument types: notification, bye-law, policy, circular, office memorandum, zoning-plan condition, court order. I expect that list is wrong. **Where does one type beat another?**

— **What can actually be sanctioned today** on a Gurgaon plotted residential plot, and whether that July suspension still stands. Also whether anything else is quietly stayed or on hold in the area you pick, technically still in the book but unusable. Those are invisible to me and obvious to you.

— **Two documents, if they are easy.** The paperwork a builder actually arrives with, from a live file where the owner is happy to help or an old closed one with names blacked out. And a site plan you have the right to share, yours rather than a client's. If neither is clean to send, describe the stack to me on a call instead. That works nearly as well.

— **The 2BHK,** when you are next at a desk. The three worst things, not a markup. Whatever you say becomes the bar every drawing after it has to clear.

— **Money.** Half an hour on the phone, and the same call can settle what you and I are to each other in this.

And the one I would most like answered: if this software were yours to point, what would you build with it? I would rather hear that than have you grade my plan.